

καρδίῃ, ἄλληκτον πολεμίζειν ἥδ' ἐ μάχεσθαι.

Ἥρη δ' εἰσεῖδε χρυσόθρονος ὀφθαλμοῖσι
στᾶσ' ἐξ Οὐλύμποιο ἀπὸ ρίου· αὐτίκα δ' ἔγνω

155 τὸν μὲν ποιπνύοντα μάχην ἀνὰ κυδιάνειραν
αὐτοκασίγνητον καὶ δαέρα, χαῖρε δὲ θυμῷ·
Ζῆνα δ' ἐπ' ἀκροτάτης κορυφῆς πολυπίδακος Ἰδης
ἤμενον εἰσεῖδε, στυγερός δέ οἱ ἔπλετο θυμῷ.

μερμήριξε δ' ἔπειτα βοῶπις πότνια Ἥρη
160 ὅπως ἑξαπάφοιτο Διὸς νόον αἰγίοχοιο.
ἦδε δέ οἱ κατὰ θυμὸν ἀρίστη φαίνεται βουλή,
ἐλθεῖν εἰς Ἰδην εὖ ἐντύνασαν ἑ αὐτήν,
εἴ πως ἰμεύριται παραδραθέειν φιλότῃ
ἧ χροῇ, τῷ δ' ὕπνον ἀπήμονά τε λιάρὸν τε
165 χεύῃ ἐπὶ βλεφάροισιν ἰδὲ φρεσὶ πευκαλίμησι.
βῆ δ' ἴμεν ἐς θάλαμον, τὸν οἱ φίλος υἱὸς ἔτευξεν
Ἥφαιστος, πυκινὰς δὲ θύρας σταθμοῖσιν ἐπήρσε
κληῖδι κρυπτῇ, τὴν δ' οὐ θεὸς ἄλλος ἀνῶγεν·
ἐνθ' ἧ γ' εἰσελθοῦσα θύρας ἐπέθηκε φαεινὰς.

170 ἀμβροσίῃ μὲν πρῶτον ἀπὸ χροὸς ἱμερόεντος
λύματα πάντα κάθηρεν, ἀλέψατο δὲ λίπ' ἐλαίῳ
ἀμβροσίῳ ἑδανῷ, τό ρά οἱ τεθυμένον ἦεν
τοῦ καὶ κινυμένοιο Διὸς κατὰ χαλκοβατὲς δῶ
ἔμψης ἐς γαῖαν τε καὶ οὐρανὸν ἵκετ' ἀντμή.

175 τῷ ῥ' ἧ γε χροά καλὸν ἀλευραμένη ἰδὲ χαίτας
πεξαμένη χερσὶ πλοκάμους ἔπλεξε φαεινοὺς
καλοὺς ἀμβροσίους¹³ ἐκ κράατος ἀθανάτοιο.
ἀμφὶ δ' ἄρ' ἀμβρόσιον ἑανὸν ἔσαθ', ὃν οἱ Ἀθήνη
ἔξυσ' ἀσκήσασα, τίθει δ' ἐνὶ δαίδαλα πολλὰ·

Achaean he roused great strength to war and to battle without ceasing.

Now Hera of the golden throne was standing on a peak of Olympus and looked down on him, and immediately recognized him as he went busily about in the battle where men win glory, her own brother and her brother-in-law; and she rejoiced at heart. And Zeus she noticed seated on the topmost peak of many-fountained Ida, and hateful was he to her heart. Then she took thought, the ox-eyed queenly Hera, how she might distract the mind of Zeus who bears the aegis. And this plan seemed to her mind the best, to go to Ida, when she had beautifully adorned herself, to see if he might long to lie by her side and embrace her body in love, and she might shed a warm and gentle sleep on his eyelids and his cunning mind. So she set out to go to her chamber that her dear son Hephaestus had fashioned for her, fitting strong doors to the doorposts with a secret bolt that no other god could open. There she entered in, and closed the bright doors. With ambrosia first did she cleanse every stain from her lovely body, and anointed herself richly with oil, ambrosial, soft, and of rich fragrance; if this were but shaken in the palace of Zeus with threshold of bronze, its scent would reach to earth and heaven. With this she anointed her lovely body, and she combed her hair, and with her hands plaited the bright tresses, fair and ambrosial, that streamed from her immortal head. Then she clothed herself in an ambrosial robe which Athene had worked and smoothed for her, and had

¹³ ἀμβροσίους: καὶ μεγάλους.

- 180 χρυσεΐης δ' ἐνετῆσι κατὰ στῆθος περονᾶτο.
ζώσατο δὲ ζώνη ἑκατὸν θυσάνοις ἀραρυΐη,
ἐν δ' ἄρα ἔρματα ἦκεν ἐντρήτοισι λοβοῖσι
τρίγληνα μορόεντα· χάρις δ' ἀπελάμπετο πολλή.
κρηδέμνω δ' ἐφύπερθε καλύψατο δῖα θεᾶων
185 καλῶ νηγατέω· λευκὸν δ' ἦν ἡέλιος ὥς·
ποσσὶ δ' ὑπὸ λιπαροῖσιν ἐδήσατο καλὰ πέδιλα.
αὐτὰρ ἐπεὶ δὴ πάντα περὶ χροῖ θήκατο κόσμον,
βῆ ῥ' ἵμεν ἐκ θαλάμοιο, καλεσσομένη δ' Ἀφροδίτην
τῶν ἄλλων ἀπάνευθε θεῶν πρὸς μῦθον ἔειπε·
190 "ἦ ῥά νύ μοι τι πίθοιο, φίλον τέκος, ὅττι κεν εἴπω,
ἦέ κεν ἀρνήσαιο, κοτεσσομένη τό γε θυμῷ,
οὐνεκ' ἐγὼ Δαναοῖσι, σὺ δὲ Τρώεσσιν ἀρήγεις;"
Τὴν δ' ἡμείβετ' ἔπειτα Διὸς θυγάτηρ Ἀφροδίτη·
"Ἥρη, πρέσβα θεά, θύγατερ μέγαλοιο Κρόνοιο,
195 αὐδα ὃ τι φρονέεις· τελέσαι δέ με θυμὸς ἄνωγεν,
εἰ δύναιμι τελέσαι γε καὶ εἰ τετελεσμένον ἐστίν."
Τὴν δὲ δολοφρονέουσα προσηύδα πότνια Ἥρη·
"δὸς νῦν μοι φιλόττητα καὶ ἥμερον, ᾧ τε σὺ πάντας
δαμνᾷ ἀθανάτους ἠδὲ θνητοὺς ἀνθρώπους.
200 εἶμι γὰρ ὀφιομένη πολυφόρβου πείρατα γαίης,
Ὠκεανόν τε, θεῶν γένεσιν, καὶ μητέρα Τηθύν,
οἳ με σφοῖσι δόμοισιν ἐν τρέφον ἠδ' ἀτίταλλον,
δεξάμενοι Ῥείας, ὅτε τε Κρόνον εὐρύοπα Ζεὺς
γαίης νέρθε καθεῖσε καὶ ἀτρυγέτοιο θαλάσσης·
205 τοὺς εἶμ' ὀφιομένη, καὶ σφ' ἄκριτα νείκεα λύσω·
ἤδη γὰρ δηρὸν χρόνον ἀλλήλων ἀπέχονται
εὐνῆς καὶ φιλόττητος, ἐπεὶ χόλος ἔμπεσε θυμῷ.

set on it many embroideries; and she pinned it at the breast with brooches of gold, and she girt about her a belt set with one hundred tassels, and in her pierced ears she put earrings with three clustering drops; and abundant grace shone from them. And with a veil over all did the fair goddess veil herself, a veil fair and bright, all glistening, and it was white as the sun; and beneath her shining feet she bound her fair sandals. But when she had decked her body with all adornment, she went out from her chamber and, calling Aphrodite to her apart from the other gods, she spoke to her, saying: "Will you now heed me, dear child, in what I shall say? Or will you refuse me, being resentful at heart because I give aid to the Danaans and you to the Trojans?"

Then made answer to her Aphrodite, daughter of Zeus: "Hera, honored goddess, daughter of great Cronos, speak what is in your mind; my heart commands me to fulfill it, if fulfill it I can, and it is a thing that has fulfillment."

Then with crafty thought spoke to her queenly Hera: "Give me now love and desire, with which you subdue all immortals and mortal men. For I am going to visit the limits of the all-nurturing earth, and Oceanus, from whom the gods are sprung, and mother Tethys, who lovingly nursed and cherished me in their halls when they had taken me from Rhea, when Zeus, whose voice resounds afar, thrust Cronos down to live beneath earth and the unresting sea. Them I am going to visit, and will loose for them their endless strife, for now for a long time they have been holding aloof from one another, from the marriage bed and from love, since wrath has fallen on their hearts. If by words I

εἰ κείνῳ γ' ἐπέεσσι παραιπεπιθοῦσα φίλον κῆρ
εἰς εὐνὴν ἀνέσαιμι ὁμωθῆναι φιλότῃτι,

210 αἰεὶ κέ σφι φίλῃ τε καὶ αἰδοίῃ καλεοίμην."

Τὴν δ' αὖτε προσέειπε φιλομειδῆς Ἀφροδίτη·
"οὐκ ἔστ' οὐδὲ ἔοικε τεὸν ἔπος ἀρνήσασθαι·
Ζηνὸς γὰρ τοῦ ἀρίστου ἐν ἀγκοίνῃσιν ἰαύεις."¹⁴

Ἦ, καὶ ἀπὸ στήθεσφιν ἐλύσατο κεστὸν ἱμάντα
215 ποικίλον, ἔνθα τέ οἱ θελκτῆρια πάντα τέτυκτο·
ἐνθ' ἐνὶ μὲν φιλότῃ, ἐν δ' ἱμερος, ἐν δ' ὀαριστὺς
πάρφασις, ἣ τ' ἔκλεψε νόον πύκα περ φρονεόντων.
τόν ῥά οἱ ἔμβαλε χερσὶν ἔπος τ' ἔφατ' ἔκ τ' ὀνόμαζε·
"τῇ νῦν, τοῦτον ἱμάντα τεῶ ἐγκάτθεο κόλπῳ,

220 ποικίλον, ᾧ ἐνὶ πάντα τετεύχεται· οὐδέ σέ φημι
ἀπρηκτόν γε νέεσθαι, ὅ τι φρεσὶ σῇσι μενοινᾷς."

Ὡς φάτο, μείδῃσεν δὲ βοῶπις πότνια Ἥρη,
μειδήσασα δ' ἔπειτα ἐῶ¹⁵ ἐγκάτθετο κόλπῳ.

Ἥ μὲν ἔβη πρὸς δῶμα Διὸς θυγάτηρ Ἀφροδίτη,
225 Ἥρη δ' αἵξασα λίπεν ῥίον Οὐλύμποιο,
Πιερίην δ' ἐπιβᾶσα καὶ Ἠμαθίην ἐρατεινὴν
σεύατ' ἐφ' ἵπποπόλων Θρηκῶν ὄρεα νιφόεντα,
ἀκροτάτας κορυφάς, οὐδὲ χθόνα μάρπτε ποδοῖν·
ἐξ Ἀθώῳ δ' ἐπὶ πόντον ἐβήσето κυμαίνοντα,
230 Λῆμνον δ' εἰσαφίκανε, πόλιν θείοιο Θόαντος.
ἐνθ' ὕπνῳ ξύμβλητο, κασιγνήτῳ Θανάτοιο,
ἐν τ' ἄρα οἱ φῦ χειρὶ ἔπος τ' ἔφατ' ἔκ τ' ὀνόμαζεν·
"ὕπνε, ἄναξ πάντων τε θεῶν πάντων τ' ἀνθρώπων,
ἡμὲν δὴ ποτ' ἐμὸν ἔπος ἔκλυσες, ἥδ' ἔτι καὶ νῦν
235 πείθεις· ἐγὼ δέ κέ τοι ἰδέω χάριν ἡμᾶτα πάντα.

were to persuade the hearts of these two, and bring them back to bed to be joined together in love, ever should I be called dear by them and honored."

To her again spoke in answer laughter-loving Aphrodite: "It cannot be, nor is it right, that I should refuse your words; for you sleep in the arms of mightiest Zeus."

She spoke, and loosed from her bosom the embroidered strap, inlaid, in which are fashioned all manner of allurements; in it is love, in it desire, in it dalliance—persuasion that steals the senses even of the wise. This she placed in her hands, and spoke and addressed her: "Take now and place in your bosom this strap, inlaid, in which all things are fashioned; I say you will not return with that unaccomplished, whatever in your heart you desire."

So she spoke, and ox-eyed queenly Hera smiled, and smiling placed the strap in her bosom.

She then went to her house, the daughter of Zeus, Aphrodite, but Hera darted down and left the peak of Olympus; on Pieria she stepped and lovely Emathia, and sped over the snowy mountains of the Thracian horsemen, over their topmost peaks, and grazed not the ground with her feet; and from Athos she stepped on to the billowy sea, and so came to Lemnos, the city of godlike Thoas. There she met Sleep, the brother of Death; and she clasped him by the hand, and spoke and addressed him: "Sleep, lord of all gods and all men, if ever you heard a word of mine, so even now obey, and I will owe you thanks all my days. Lull to

¹⁴ Line 213 was rejected by Aristophanes and Aristarchus.

¹⁵ ἐῶ: μέσῳ Zenodotus.

- κοίμησόν μοι Ζηνὸς ὑπ' ὀφρύσιν ὅσσε φαεινῶ,
 αὐτίκ' ἐπεὶ κεν ἐγὼ παραλέξομαι ἐν φιλότῳ.
 δῶρα δέ τοι δώσω καλὸν θρόνον, ἄφθιτον αἰεὶ,
 χρύσειον· Ἥφαιστος δέ κ' ἐμὸς πάϊς ἀμφιγυῖς
 240 τεύξει' ἀσκήσας, ὑπὸ δὲ θρήνῳ ποσὶν ἦσει,
 τῷ κεν ἐπισχοίης λιπαροὺς πόδας εἰλαπινάζων."
 Τὴν δ' ἀπαμειβόμενος προσεφώνεε νήδυμος Ὕπ-
 νος·
 "Ἡρη, πρέσβα θεά, θύγατερ μεγάλοιο Κρόνιοι,
 ἄλλον μὲν κεν ἐγὼ γε θεῶν αἰεγενετάων
 245 ῥεία κατενῆσαιμι, καὶ ἂν ποταμοῖο ῥέεθρα
 Ὀκεανοῦ, ὅς περ γένεσις πάντεσσι τέτυκται·
 Ζηνὸς δ' οὐκ ἂν ἐγὼ γε Κρονίου ἀσσον ἰκοίμην,
 οὐδὲ κατενῆσαιμ', ὅτε μὴ αὐτός γε κελεύει.
 ἦδη γάρ με καὶ ἄλλο τετὶ ἐπίνυσσεν ἐφετμή,
 250 ἥματι τῷ ὅτε κείνος ὑπέρθυμος Διὸς υἱὸς
 ἔπλεεν Ἰλιόθεν, Τρώων πόλιν ἐξαλαπάξας.
 ἦ τοι ἐγὼ μὲν ἔθελξα Διὸς νόον αἰγιόχοιο
 νήδυμος ἀμφιχυθείς· σὺ δέ οἱ κακὰ μήσαο θυμῷ,
 ὄρσας' ἀργαλέων ἀνέμων ἐπὶ πόντον ἀήτας,
 255 καί μιν ἔπειτα Κόωνδ' εὖ ναιομένην ἀπένεικας,
 νόσφι φίλων πάντων. ὁ δ' ἐπεγρόμενος χαλέπαινε,
 ῥιπτάζων κατὰ δῶμα θεοῦς, ἐμὲ δ' ἔξοχα πάντων
 ζήτει· καὶ κέ μ' αἶστον ἀπ' αἰθέρος ἔμβαλε πόντῳ,
 εἰ μὴ Νύξ δμῆτειρα¹⁶ θεῶν ἐσάωσε καὶ ἀνδρῶν·

¹⁶ δμῆτειρα Aristarchus: μήτειρα Zenodotus and Aristophanes.

sleep the gleaming eyes of Zeus beneath his brows for me, as soon as I shall have lain down by his side in love. And gifts will I give you, a fair throne, ever imperishable, of gold, that Hephaestus, my own son, the god of the two lame legs, will fashion for you with skill, and beneath it will he set a stool for the feet, on which you may rest your shining feet when you quaff your wine."

Then sweet Sleep made answer to her, saying: "Hera, honored goddess, daughter of great Cronos, another of the gods who are for ever would I lightly lull to sleep, even if it were the streams of the river Oceanus from whom they all are sprung; but to Zeus, son of Cronos, will I neither draw near, nor lull him to slumber, unless he himself orders me. For before now on another occasion did a command of yours teach me a lesson, on the day when the glorious son of Zeus, high of heart, sailed out from Ilios, when he had sacked the city of the Trojans.¹ I distracted the mind of Zeus who bears the aegis, being shed in sweetness round about him, and you devised evil in your heart against his son when you had roused the blasts of cruel winds over the face of the deep, and then carried him away to well-peopled Cos, far from all his comrades. But Zeus, when he awakened, was angry, and flung the gods about his halls, and me above all he sought, and would have hurled me from heaven into the deep to be seen no more, if Night had not saved me—Night who subdues both gods and men. To

¹ The story of the sacking of Troy by Heracles is told in brief in 5.638-651. The events recorded in the present passage occurred as the hero was returning from Troy to Argos. In 15.18 ff we are told of the punishment meted out to Hera by Zeus, when he awakened from slumber, and in 1.590 ff of the fate of Hephaestus, who sought to bear aid to his mother. M.

- 260 τὴν ἰκόμην φεύγων, ὃ δὲ παύσατο χωόμενός περ.
 ἄζετο γὰρ μὴ Νυκτὶ θοῇ ἀποθύμια ἔρδοι.
 νῦν αὖ τοῦτό μ' ἄνωγας ἀμήχανον ἄλλο τελέσσαι."
 Τὸν δ' αὖτε προσέειπε βοῶπις πότνια Ἥρη·
 "ὦ πνε, τίη δὲ σὺ ταῦτα μετὰ φρεσὶ σῆσι μενοινᾷς;
 265 ἦ φῆς ὥς Τρώεσσιν ἀρηξέμεν εὐρύοπα Ζῆν
 ὥς Ἡρακλῆος περιχώσατο παῖδος ἐοῖο;
 ἀλλ' ἴθ', ἐγὼ δέ κέ τοι Χαρίτων μίαν ὀπλοτεράων
 δώσω ὀπυιέμεναι καὶ σὴν κεκληῆσθαι ἄκοιτιν,
 Πασιθέην, ἥς αἰὲν ἰμείρεαι ἥματα πάντα."¹⁷
 270 ὣς φάτο, χήρατο δ' Ὀϊνός, ἀμειβόμενος δὲ προσ-
 ηύδα·
 "ἄγρει νῦν μοι ὅμοσσον ἀάατον Στυγὸς ὕδωρ,
 χειρὶ δὲ τῇ ἐτέρῃ μὲν ἔλε χθόνα πονυλβότειραν,
 τῇ δ' ἐτέρῃ ἄλα μαρμαρέην, ἵνα νῶιν ἅπαντες
 μάρτυροι ᾧσ' οἱ ἔνερθε θεοὶ Κρόνον ἀμφὶς ἑόντες,
 275 ἦ μὲν ἐμοὶ δώσειν Χαρίτων μίαν ὀπλοτεράων,
 Πασιθέην, ἥς τ' αὐτὸς ἐέλδομαι ἥματα πάντα."
 ὣς ἔφατ', οὐδ' ἀπίθησε θεὰ λευκώλενος Ἥρη,
 ὅμνυε δ' ὥς ἐκέλευε, θεοὺς δ' ὀνόμηνεν ἅπαντας
 τοὺς ὑποταρταρίους, οἳ Τιτῆνες καλέονται.
 280 αὐτὰρ ἐπεὶ ῥ' ὅμοσέν τε τελεύτησέν τε τὸν ὄρκον,
 τὼ βήτην Λήμνον τε καὶ Ἴμβρον ἄστνυ λιπόντε,
 ἡέρα ἐσσαμένω, ῥίμφα πρήσσοντε κέλευθον.
 Ἰδὴν δ' ἰκέσθην πολυπίδακα, μητέρα θηρῶν,
 Λεκτόν, ὅθι πρῶτον λιπέτην ἄλα· τὼ δ' ἐπὶ χέρσου
 285 βήτην, ἀκροτάτῃ δὲ ποδῶν ὑπο σείετο ὕλη.
 ἔνθ' Ὀϊνός μὲν ἔμεινε πάρος Διὸς ὅσσε ἰδέσθαι,

her I came in my flight, and Zeus checked himself, though he was angry, for he hesitated to do anything displeasing to swift Night. And now again you command me to fulfill this, another impossible task."

To him then spoke again ox-eyed queenly Hera: "Sleep, why is it you ponder these things in your heart? Do you think that Zeus, whose voice resounds afar, will aid the Trojans in the same way he grew angry for the sake of Heracles, his own son? But come, I will give you one of the youthful Graces to wed and to be called your wife, Pasithea, for whom you have been longing all your days."

So she spoke, and Sleep rejoiced, and made answer saying: "Come now, swear to me by the inviolable water of Styx, and with one hand lay hold of the bounteous earth, and with the other the shimmering sea, so that all the gods who are below with Cronos may be witnesses for us two, that you truly will give me one of the youthful Graces, Pasithea, for whom I have been longing all my days."

So he spoke, and the goddess, white-armed Hera, failed not to obey, but swore as he said, and invoked by name all the gods below Tartarus, who are called Titans. But when she had sworn and made an end of the oath, the two of them left the cities of Lemnos and Imbros, and clothed about in mist went out, speeding lightly on their way. To many-fountained Ida they came, mother of wild beasts, to Lectum, where first they left the sea; and they went on to the dry land, and the topmost forest quivered beneath their feet. There Sleep halted, before the eyes of

¹⁷ Line 269 is omitted in most MSS.

- εἰς ἐλάτην ἀναβὰς περιμήκετον, ἥ τότ' ἐν Ἰδῇ
 μακροτάτῃ πεφυυῖα δι' ἡέρος αἰθέρ' ἵκανε·
 ἐνθ' ἦσθ' ὅζοισιν πεπυκασμένος εἰλατίνοισιν,
 290 ὄρνιθι λιγυρῇ ἐναλίγκιος, ἦν τ' ἐν ὄρεσσι
 χαλκίδα κυκλήσκουσι θεοί, ἄνδρες δὲ κύμινδιν.
 Ἥρῃ δὲ κραιπνῶς προσεβήσετο Γάργαρον ἄκρον
 Ἰδῆς ὑψηλῆς· ἶδε δὲ νεφεληγερέτα Ζεὺς.
 ὥς δ' ἶδεν, ὥς μιν ἔρωσ πυκινὰς φρένας ἀμφεκάλυψεν,
 295 οἶον ὅτε πρῶτόν περ ἐμισγέσθην φιλότῃ,
 εἰς εὐνὴν φοιτῶντε, φίλους λήθοντε τοκῆας.
 στῇ δ' αὐτῆς προπάρουθεν ἔπος τ' ἔφατ' ἐκ τ' ὀνό-
 μαζεν·
 “Ἥρῃ, πῇ μεμανῖα κατ' Οὐλύμπου τόδ' ἱκάνεις;
 ἵπποι δ' οὐ παρέασι καὶ ἄρματα, τῶν κ' ἐπιβαίης.”
 300 Τὸν δὲ δολοφρονέουσα προσηύδα πότνια Ἥρῃ·
 “ἔρχομαι ὀψομένη πολυφόρβου πείρατα γαίης,
 Ὠκεανόν τε, θεῶν γένεσιν, καὶ μητέρα Τηθύν,
 οἷ μὲ σφοῖσι δόμοισιν ἐν τρέφον ἡδ' ἀτίταλλον·
 τοὺς εἰμ' ὀψομένη, καὶ σφ' ἄκριτα νείκεα λύσω.”¹⁸
 305 ἦδη γὰρ δηρὸν χρόνον ἀλλήλων ἀπέχονται
 εὐνῆς καὶ φιλότῃος, ἐπεὶ χόλος ἔμπεσε θυμῷ.
 ἵπποι δ' ἐν πυρμυωρείῃ πολυπίδακος Ἰδῆς
 ἐστᾶσ', οἷ μ' οἴσουσιν ἐπὶ τραφερὴν τε καὶ ὑγρὴν.
 νῦν δὲ σεῦ εἵνεκα δεῦρο κατ' Οὐλύμπου τόδ' ἱκάνω,
 310 μή πῶς μοι μετέπειτα χολώσεται, αἶ κε σιωπῇ
 οἴχωμαι πρὸς δῶμα βαθυρρόου Ὠκεανοῖο.”
 Τὴν δ' ἀπαμειβόμενος προσέφη νεφεληγερέτα
 Ζεὺς·

Zeus saw him, and mounted up on an exceedingly tall fir tree, the highest that then grew in Ida; and it reached up through the mists into heaven. On it he sat, hidden by the branches of the fir, in the likeness of a clear-voiced mountain bird that the gods call chalcis, but men call cymindis.

But Hera swiftly came up to topmost Gargarus, the peak of lofty Ida, and Zeus, the cloud-gatherer, saw her. And when he saw her, then love engulfed his shrewd mind, just as when they first had joined in love, going off to bed unbeknownst to their dear parents. And he stood before her, and spoke, and addressed her: “Hera, where are you off to, coming down here from Olympus in this way? Your horses are not at hand, nor your chariot, on which you might mount.”

Then with crafty mind the queenly Hera spoke to him: “I am going to visit the limits of the all-nurturing earth, and Oceanus, from whom the gods are sprung, and mother Tethys, who lovingly nursed me and cherished me in their halls. Them I am going to visit, and will loose for them their endless strife, for now for a long time they have been holding aloof from one another, from the marriage bed and from love, since wrath has fallen on their hearts. And my horses stand at the foot of many-fountained Ida, my horses that will carry me both over the solid land and the waters of the sea. But now it is because of you that I have come here down from Olympus, lest perhaps you may be angry with me in future, if without telling you I go to the house of deep-flowing Oceanus.”

In answer spoke to her Zeus, the cloud-gatherer:

¹⁸ Lines 304–306 were rejected by Zenodotus and Aristophanes.

- “Ἡρη, κείσε μὲν ἔστι καὶ ὕστερον ὀρμηθῆναι,
 νῶι δ’ ἄγ’ ἐν φιλότῃ τράπειομεν εὐνηθέντε.
 315 οὐ γάρ πώ ποτέ μ’ ὦδε θεᾶς ἔρος οὐδὲ γυναικὸς
 θυμὸν ἐνὶ στήθεσσι περιπροχυθεὶς ἐδάμασεν,
 οὐδ’ ὅπ’ ἡρασάμην Ἰξιονίης ἀλόχοιο,¹⁹
 ἢ τέκε Πειρίθοον, θεόφιν μῆστωρ’ ἀτάλαντον
 οὐδ’ ὅτε περ Δανάης καλλισφύρου Ἀκρισιῶνης,
 320 ἢ τέκε Περσῆα, πάντων ἀριδείκετον ἀνδρῶν
 οὐδ’ ὅτε Φοῖνικος κούρης τηλεκλειτοῖο,
 ἢ τέκε μοι Μίνων τε καὶ ἀντίθεον Ῥαδάμανθυν
 οὐδ’ ὅτε περ Σεμέλης οὐδ’ Ἀλκμήνης ἐνὶ Θήβῃ,
 ἢ ῥ’ Ἡρακλῆα κρατερόφρονα γείνατο παῖδα·
 325 ἢ δὲ Διώνυσον Σεμέλη τέκε, χάρμα βροτοῖσιν
 οὐδ’ ὅτε Δήμητρος καλλιπλοκάμοιο ἀνάσσης,
 οὐδ’ ὅποτε Λητοῦς ἐρικυδέος, οὐδὲ σεῦ αὐτῆς,
 ὥς σέο νῦν ἔραμαι καί με γλυκὺς ἥμερος αἰρεῖ.”
 Τὸν δὲ δολοφρονέουσα προσηύδα πότνια Ἡρῇ·
 330 “αἰνότατε Κρονίδη, ποῖον τὸν μῦθον ἔειπες.
 εἰ νῦν ἐν φιλότῃ λιλαίει εὐνηθῆναι
 ἴδης ἐν κορυφῇσι, τὰ δὲ προπέφανται ἅπαντα·
 πῶς κ’ ἔοι, εἴ τις νῶι θεῶν αἰεγενετάων
 εὐδοντ’ ἀθρήσειε, θεοῖσι δὲ πᾶσι μετελθὼν
 335 πεφράδοι; οὐκ ἂν ἐγὼ γε τεὸν πρὸς δῶμα νεοίμην
 ἐξ εὐνῆς ἀνστᾶσα, νεμεσσητὸν δέ κεν εἴη.
 ἀλλ’ εἰ δὴ ῥ’ ἐθέλεις καί τοι φίλον ἔπλετο θυμῷ,
 ἔστιν τοιθάλαμος, τόν τοι φίλος υἱὸς ἔτευξεν
 Ἡφαιστος, πυκινὰς δὲ θύρας σταθμοῖσιν ἐπήρσεν·
 340 ἔνθ’ ἵομεν κείμεντες, ἐπεὶ νύ τοι εὐαδεν εὐνή.”

“Hera, you may go there later. But for us two, come, let us take our joy bedded together in love; for never yet has desire for goddess or mortal woman so shed itself about me and overmastered the heart within my breast—not even when I was seized with love of Ixion’s wife, who bore Peirithous, the peer of the gods in counsel; nor of Danaë of the fair ankles, Acrisius’ daughter, who bore Perseus, preeminent above all warriors; nor of the daughter of far-famed Phoenix, who bore me Minos and godlike Rhadamanthys; nor of Semele, nor of Alcmena in Thebes, and she brought forth Heracles, her son stout of heart, and Semele bore Dionysus, the joy of mortals; nor of Demeter, the fair-tressed queen; nor of glorious Leto; nor yet of yourself, as now I love you, and sweet desire lays hold of me.”

Then with crafty mind the queenly Hera spoke to him: “Most dread son of Cronos, what a word you have said! If now you are eager to be bedded in love on the peaks of Ida and everything is plain to view, what if some one of the gods who are for ever should look on us two as we sleep, and should go and tell it to all the gods? Then I at least could not arise from the bed and go again to your house; that would be a shameful thing. But if you really are so minded, and it is your heart’s pleasure, you have a chamber that your dear son Hephaestus fashioned for you, fitting strong doors to the door posts. There let us go and lie down, since the bed is clearly your desire.”

¹⁹ Lines 317–327 were rejected by Aristophanes and Aristarchus.

Τὴν δ' ἀπαμειβόμενος προσέφη νεφεληγερέτα
Ζεὺς·

“Ἥρη, μήτε θεῶν τό γε δίδιθι μήτε τιν' ἀνδρῶν
ὄψεσθαι τοῖόν τοι ἐγὼ νέφος ἀμφικαλύψω
χρύσειον· οὐδ' ἂν νῶϊ διαδράκοι Ἥελίος περ,

345 οὐ τέ καὶ ὀξύτατον πέλεται φάος εἰσοράασθαι.”

Ἥ ῥα, καὶ ἀγκὰς ἔμαρπτε Κρόνου παῖς ἦν παρά-
κοιτιν·

τοῖσι δ' ὑπὸ χθὼν δία φύεν νεοθηλέα ποιήν,
λωτόν θ' ἐρσήεντα ἰδὲ κρόκον ἦδ' ὑάκινθον
πυκνὸν καὶ μαλακόν, ὃς ἀπὸ χθονὸς ὑψόσ' ἔεργε.²⁰

350 τῷ ἔνι λεξάσθην, ἐπὶ δὲ νεφέλην ἔσσαντο
καλὴν χρυσεῖην· στιλπναὶ δ' ἀπέπιπτον ἔερσαι.

“Ὡς ὁ μὲν ἀτρέμας εὐδε πατὴρ ἀνὰ Γαργάρῳ ἄκρῳ,
ὑπνῳ καὶ φιλότῳ δαμείς, ἔχε δ' ἀγκὰς ἄκοιτιν·
βῆ δὲ θέειν ἐπὶ νῆας Ἀχαιῶν νήδυμος Ὕπνος

355 ἀγγελίην ἐρέων γαῖόχῳ Ἐννοσιγαίῳ·
ἀγχοῦ δ' ἰστάμενος ἔπεα πτερόεντα προσηύδα·

“πρόφρων νῦν Δαναοῖσι, Ποσειδάων, ἐπάμυνε,
καὶ σφιν κῦδος ὅπαζε μίνυνθά περ, ὅφρ' ἔτι εὐδῇ
Ζεὺς, ἐπεὶ αὐτῷ ἐγὼ μαλακὸν περὶ κῶμα κάλυψα·

360 Ἥρη δ' ἐν φιλότῳ παρήπαφεν εὐνηθῆναι.”

“Ὡς εἰπὼν ὁ μὲν ὤχετ' ἐπὶ κλυτὰ φύλ' ἀνθρώπων,
τὸν δ' ἔτι μᾶλλον ἀνῆκεν ἀμυνέμεναι Δαναοῖσιν.

αὐτίκα δ' ἐν πρῶτοισι μέγα προθορῶν ἐκέλευσεν·

“Ἀργεῖοι, καὶ δὴ αὖτε μεθίεμεν Ἐκτορι νίκην

365 Πριαμίδῃ, ἵνα νῆας ἔλῃ καὶ κῦδος ἄρῃται;
ἀλλ' ὁ μὲν οὕτω φησὶ καὶ εὐχεται,²¹ οὐνεκ' Ἀχιλλεὺς

In answer to her spoke Zeus, the cloud-gatherer:
“Hera, fear not in this that any god or man will see, with
such a cloud shall I enfold you, a cloud of gold. Through it
not even Helios could discern us, though his sight is the
keenest of all for seeing.”

At that the son of Cronos clasped his wife in his arms,
and beneath them the bright earth made fresh-sprung
grass to grow, and dewy lotus, and crocus, and hyacinth
thick and soft that kept them from the ground. On this they
lay, and were clothed about with a cloud, fair and golden,
from which fell drops of glistening dew.

Thus in quiet slept the father on topmost Gargarus, by
sleep and love subdued, and clasped his wife in his arms.
But sweet Sleep set out to run to the ships of the Argives to
bring word to the Enfolder and Shaker of Earth. And he
came up to him, and spoke winged words, saying: “Eagerly
now, Poseidon, assist the Danaans, and grant them glory,
though it be for a little time, while yet Zeus sleeps; since
over him I have shed soft slumber, and Hera has tricked
him to bed with her in love.”

So he spoke and went away to the glorious tribes of
men, but Poseidon he set on even more to assist the
Danaans. Immediately then he leapt out among the fore-
most, and cried aloud: “Argives, are we to yield victory to
Hector, son of Priam, so that he may take the ships and win
glory for himself? But so he says, and boasts that it will be,

²⁰ ὃς ἀπὸ χθονὸς ὑψόσ' ἔεργε: ἵν' ἀπὸ χθονὸς ἀγκαζέσθην
Zenodotus.

²¹ εὐχεται: ἔλπεται Zenodotus.